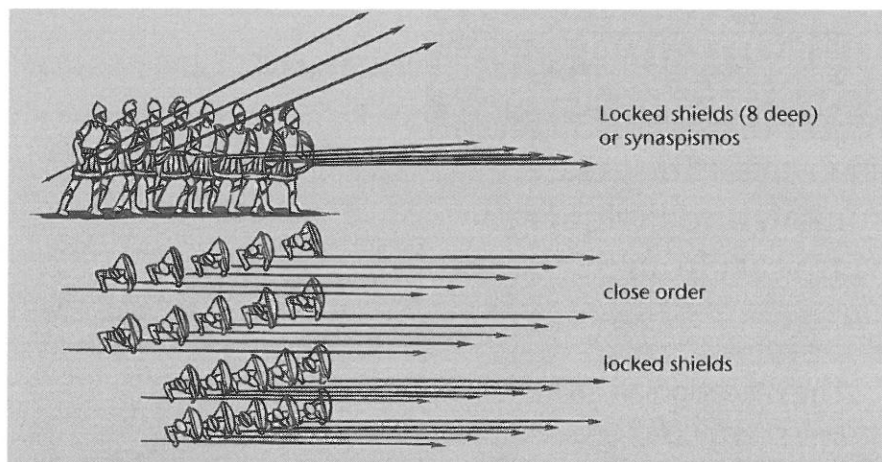
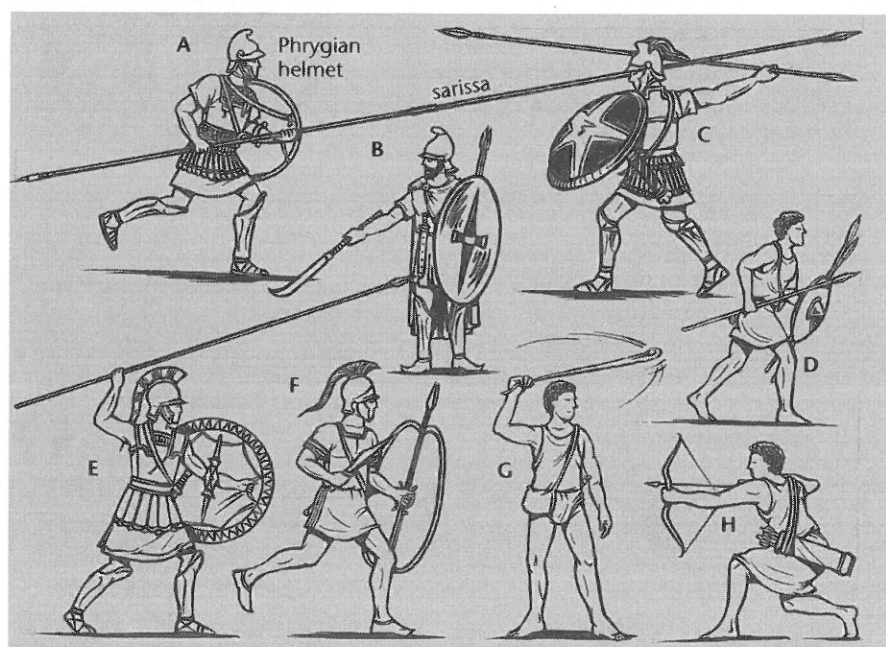


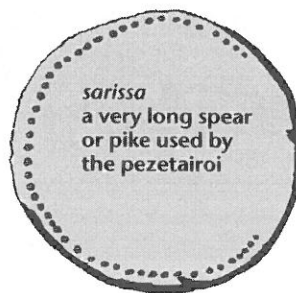


The Macedonian phalanx. What difficulties might a pezetairos have when trying to use a sarissa in battle?



Infantry types in Alexander's army. Describe their armour and weaponry.

- A Macedonian pezetairos
- B Thracian peltast
- C Macedonian hypaspist
- D Agrianian javelin man
- E Hoplite
- F Greek peltast
- G Slinger (psiloi)
- H Archer (psiloi)



sarissa
a very long spear
or pike used by
the pezetairos

tairos or pikeman. According to Diodorus Siculus (16.3) Philip reformed the fighting formations, creating the Macedonian phalanx. He gave his troops a new weapon—the sarissa or pike.

The phalanx and sarissa

A phalanx was a formation of infantrymen in ranks 8 to 16 deep and up to 16 or 20 wide, who fought as a block of men. The pezetairos held the sarissa—a pike approximately 5.5 metres in length—in both hands to fight. All of Philip's and Alexander's enemies fought with much shorter spears. Greek hoplites' spears were 2.5 metres long, and Persians' spears about 1.8 metres long. When a

Macedonian pike phalanx engaged a Greek or Persian spear phalanx, the spearman was at a great disadvantage. He could not reach his Macedonian opponent until he passed through some three or four pike points. Even then he could not put as much strength into his thrust as his opponent could, because he used his spear with one hand. The pezetairos also carried a sword for closer fighting.

Fighting costumes

The pezetairos wore leather tunics or cuirasses, occasionally bronze greaves on their shins and bronze helmets most commonly of the 'Phrygian' type. They also carried small shields, which hung from the neck by a leather strap. The shield, called a *pelta* or *aspis* was about 60 centimetres in diameter and probably made from bronze. Archaeologists have discovered excellent examples of pezetairos equipment, most notably at the Great Tomb of Vergina, believed to belong to Philip himself.

Discipline and organisation

The Macedonians also possessed superior discipline and organisation. Philip organised the pezetairos into 12 or 15 *taxeis* of about 1500 soldiers. Each was raised from one of the Macedonian 'provinces'. This meant that the troops were better able to be controlled on the battlefield in difficult situations. Alexander took 6 to 8 of these *taxeis* with him when he crossed into Asia and left the rest with Antipater to control Greece.

Training for the pezetairos included 50-kilometre marches, even in peacetime, in full kit and carrying rations for thirty days. Women were banned from the armies' camps, as were baggage wagons and weakening customs such as hot baths! Servants were limited to one per every ten infantry. These servants were also used as light infantry or *psiloi* and fought with javelins or slings.

The hypaspists or guards

These troops were an elite group of men trained as the king's own. There were three units of 1000 men. They